



GREY BANNER ALERT



SHW Serious Incident (SI) – Final Notice

Date of Incident	24 May 2024	Time of Incident	2:44pm
Directorate / Region	RMO – Mid West Gascoyne	Main Roads or Contractor	Contractor
EQSafe Event Type	Damage / Loss	EQSafe Incident Number	40634
Actual Consequence	Minor	Potential Consequence	Major

Incident Short Description	Driver fell asleep at the wheel and loses control of the vehicle on journey to site.
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Executive Summary

On Friday 24 May 2024 at around 10:05am, four Traffic Controllers (TC) departed their company's depot enroute to site. The convoy consisted of two single occupants in two separate vehicles, and one vehicle with two occupants.

At approximately 2:32pm during the journey, a driver who was in one of the vehicles on their own had fallen asleep, they travelled along the shoulder for around 129m. The vehicle has then hit a rutted area, causing the vehicle to roll over and land on the shoulder on its roof.

The crew travelling at the front of the convoy have noticed that the rear vehicle was no longer there and have travelled back to see where the vehicle was.

The crew have witnessed the vehicle on its roof and the driver safely out of the vehicle.

Emergency Services were called and have arrived at the site to assess the driver. The driver was taken to a medical centre and was confirmed by a medical practitioner to have no injuries. The vehicle involved was damaged and later towed from the crash location.

However, post incident AOD testing, the driver and two of the other in the convoy have returned non-negative AOD test results.

Incident Photos

Traffic Control Vehicle Overturned in V-Drain

Contributing Factors

- Both prescribed and illicit drugs were found in the driver's system. Driver did not declare any medication to their employer.
- Driver had an interrupted sleep the previous night after taking their sick child to hospital, which led to only getting about 4hrs of sleep. Supervisor was made aware of the workers' fatigue issue in the morning and did not put suitable controls in place to manage the drivers' fatigue.
- No journey management plan and no set communication protocol in place.
- The crews driving by themselves which increase the risk of fatigue.

Corrective Actions

- Contractor company to create a fatigue management process including a journey management plan.
- Better planning to ensure where possible that crew members travel in pairs to provide the option of rotating drivers to minimise the risk of fatigue.
- Workers returning non-negative and confirmatory test results removed from site.

Additional Issues / Learnings

- Poor sleep or lack of sleep prior to a long drive contributes to the prevalence of fatigue issues.
- A poor or ineffective journey management process increases travel-related risks during long and remote journeys.
- Declaring medications to your employer which may impact on your ability to do your job safely is part of a worker's duty of care.
- Driving impaired by alcohol or drugs remains one of the biggest contributors to road trauma in the state with nearly 50 people killed in alcohol and drug related crashes every year in WA.



Critical Risk:

This serious potential incident aligns with the Main Roads Critical Risk Profile relating to
Vehicles and Driving

Distribution of Notice

Main Roads Personnel and Contracting Organisations